CSIS JAPAN CHAIR

Japan Daily Brief

Monday, November 9, 2026

1,868 words · 7 min read

RE: APEC Xi-snub risk · Japan-Vietnam summit · JTI Russia seizure · LDP discipline · FX intervention data · Nikkei bounce · JSR deal

NIKKEI 225	USD/JPY	BRENT	BOJ RATE
58,775.50	157.96	$94.71	1.25%
▼ -6.83%	▲ +0.03%	▲ +0.10%	

TOP STORIES

CHINA-JAPAN

Japan Works to Shield Takaichi From Any Xi Snub at China Summit

Japanese government officials are making intensive diplomatic efforts to secure at least a brief encounter — described in reporting as a 'handshake' — between PM **Sanae Takaichi** and Chinese President Xi Jinping at the APEC summit in Beijing, amid uncertainty over whether Xi will grant a formal bilateral meeting given unresolved friction over Takaichi's Taiwan remarks one year ago. Multiple outlets including Bloomberg and The Straits Times report that Tokyo fears a public snub would damage Takaichi's political standing and complicate Japan-China relations heading into 2027.

BLOOMBERG

ECONOMY-BOJ

Japan stepped in to buy one-day record 7.98 tril. yen in July: gov't data

Newly released government data confirm Japan bought *¥7.98 trillion* ($50.4 billion) in the foreign exchange market on July 30 — a one-day record — to arrest yen depreciation; Nikkei Asia reported the disclosure underscores the challenge of sustainably reversing a structurally weak yen at USD/JPY levels that remain above 157 today.

MAINICHI

ECONOMY-BOJ

Japan Tobacco shares untraded after all entities in Russia placed under temporary administration

Reuters reported Japan Tobacco International shares were halted from trading after Russia placed all of Japan Tobacco's entities in Russia under temporary administration via a presidential order — the most direct economic action against a major Japanese corporate asset in Russia to date, extending the Putin-signed seizure reported last week beyond manufacturing units to the full corporate structure.

REUTERS

POLITICS-DIET

Takaichi and LDP weigh disciplinary action for party members who abstained from food tax vote

The LDP issued formal warnings (戒告) to former Prime Minister **Shigeru Ishiba** and three other members who walked out of a consumption-tax reduction bill vote — Asahi characterized the sanction of a former prime minister as unprecedented within LDP party discipline history. PM Takaichi and party leadership demanded written explanations from the abstaining lawmakers.

THE JAPAN TIMES

DEFENSE

Signing and Exchanging of Notes for Official Security Assistance (OSA) FY2026 Project to the Republic of the Philippines -The first defense equipment transfer project under Japan's OSA - Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Japan

Japan and the Philippines signed the FY2026 Official Security Assistance project agreement, marking the *first* transfer of a finished defense article — military surveillance radar — under Japan's OSA program, which provides grant-based security assistance to like-minded states in the Indo-Pacific.

MOFA

ECONOMY-BOJ

Nikkei stock index jumps over 3% on dip-buying after 3rd largest drop

The Nikkei stock index jumped briefly over *3%* Monday on dip-buying concentrated in AI- and semiconductor-related stocks, partially recovering from what multiple reports described as the third-largest single-session drop in the index's history.

MAINICHI

STAT OF THE DAY

¥7.98T

Single-day yen intervention on July 30 — largest on record

Japan bought ¥7.98 trillion ($50.4 billion) in a single day on July 30 to stem yen depreciation, according to newly released government data.

Japan stepped in to buy one-day record 7.98 tril. yen in July: gov't data (Mainichi)

JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · MONDAY, NOVEMBER 9, 2026

PM Watch: PM appeared today · 0 day(s) since last confirmed appearance — PM Takaichi is due to hold a summit with Vietnamese President To Lam in Tokyo today covering energy security, economic security, AI, and quantum technology cooperation.

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS · *Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi*

MOFA issues condolence message on Poland mass shooting

Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi issued a formal message of condolence regarding a mass shooting in Poland, per MOFA's official release.

→ Google News ↗

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS · *State Minister for Foreign Affairs HORII*

MOFA hosts incoming UN Security Council members

State Minister for Foreign Affairs Horii received courtesy calls from the Permanent Representatives of incoming members of the UN Security Council, underscoring Japan's engagement with the body ahead of its own UNSC tenure.

→ MOFA ↗

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS

Japan-Djibouti Strategic Dialogue held

Japan and Djibouti held a Strategic Dialogue, per MOFA's official announcement, extending Tokyo's partner engagement in East Africa and the Horn of Africa.

→ MOFA ↗

防衛省 · MINISTRY OF DEFENSE

Japan-Vietnam defense ministers' talks held

Japan's Defense Ministry announced that defense minister-level talks with Vietnam were held on November 9, per the MOD official release.

防衛省 · MINISTRY OF DEFENSE

Japan-US Joint Committee agreement reached

The Japan-US Joint Committee, the administrative body for US Forces Japan basing arrangements, reached an agreement per a MOD press release dated November 9; substance of the agreement was not detailed in available articles.

PERSONNEL CHANGES

Genta Koja CONFIRMED/RECENTLY ELECTED
Okinawa Governor
Genta Koja, recently elected as Okinawa Governor, stated Monday that he supports the Henoko relocation plan — a significant policy shift from his predecessor's sustained opposition. Koja simultaneously called for central-government explanations of the defense buildup's scale to Okinawa residents.

DIET SESSIONS / LDP

LDP
Controversy over PM Takaichi's absence from G7 foreign ministers' meeting resurfaces
Asahi reported that government sources questioned the stated reasons for PM Takaichi's decision to skip G7 foreign ministers' talks, with some officials noting preparations could have been completed in around an hour; the government separately denied a report that she had been drinking beforehand.

LDP

Mainichi editorial: Takaichi's 'go-it-alone style' is widening divisions one year into her tenure
Mainichi's editorial board assessed that PM Takaichi's governing approach has deepened party and public divisions in her first year, citing the food-tax vote fallout and strained China ties as evidence of compounding political costs.

PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE
JNN · Nov 2, 2026	**64.9%**	**32.5%**
ANN · Oct 19, 2026	**47.1%**	**33.3%**
Asahi · Oct 19, 2026	**50%**	**35%**
Kyodo · Oct 19, 2026	**49.1%**	**33%**
FNN · Oct 19, 2026	**62.6%**	**32.3%**
Yomiuri · Oct 19, 2026	**57%**	**30%**
NHK · Oct 14, 2026 · **26d ago**	**50.8%**	**32%**

Discourse: LDP's formal disciplinary warnings against former PM Ishiba and three other members over the food-tax vote abstention mark an escalation of intraparty conflict that Mainichi editorial framing links to PM Takaichi's 'go-it-alone style' one year into her tenure.

Poll tracker: **Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator →**

BUSINESS & ECONOMY

SEMICONDUCTORS · THE JAPAN TIMES · MITSUI CHEMICALS, JSR CORPORATION
Mitsui Chemicals to acquire JSR for $12 billion in government-backed semiconductor-materials consolidation
Mitsui Chemicals agreed to acquire **JSR Corporation** — a critical supplier of photoresists and other semiconductor materials — for *$12 billion*, furthering a government-backed push to consolidate Japan's fragmented semiconductor-materials industry and reduce vulnerability to supply-chain disruption.

FINANCE · BLOOMBERG · BERKSHIRE HATHAWAY
Berkshire Hathaway plans first Japan bond offering since April
Berkshire Hathaway is preparing its first yen-denominated bond offering since April, continuing Warren Buffett's pattern of using Japanese bonds to fund stakes in Japan's major trading houses.

MACRO · NIKKEI ASIA
FX intervention data highlight limits of yen support despite record one-day purchase
Nikkei Asia analysis of the newly disclosed July intervention data — confirming a record *¥7.98 trillion* single-day purchase on July 30 — found that the yen has not sustainably recovered, with USD/JPY still above 157, underscoring structural demand-side pressures that spot intervention cannot address alone.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH

Normal — 8 items (BOJ: 4, METI: 2, DPRK: 2)

CHINA

Japanese government officials are conducting intensive behind-the-scenes diplomacy to secure even a brief Takaichi-Xi encounter at APEC in Beijing, with multiple outlets reporting Beijing has not confirmed a formal bilateral; Global Times simultaneously ran pieces labeling Japan's posture on China relations 'misguided' and warning it will 'backfire,' while a separate Global Times report flagged Japan's deliberations over retaining the 'greatest strategic challenge' designation for China in its Three Strategic Documents review.

NORTH KOREA

North Korea's weapons testing pace has surged to twice the rate of Trump's first term, per The Star; a separate Military Watch Magazine report highlighted North Korea's top air-defense system demonstrating long-range interception capabilities — systems that bear directly on Japan's missile-defense planning.

RUSSIA

Reuters reported Japan Tobacco shares were halted after Russia placed all JTI entities — not just manufacturing units — under temporary administration via a Putin presidential order, escalating the economic seizure of Japanese corporate assets in Russia beyond the scope reported last week.

Senkaku / ECS: No new China Coast Guard intrusion or PLA activity in the Senkaku territorial waters or contiguous zone is reported in today's articles; tracker carries forward the baseline of near-daily CCG contiguous-zone presence.

> *"Japan's misguided mind-set on China relations will backfire"*
>
> Global Times (Chinese state media editorial) · Japan's misguided mind-set on China relations will backfire - Global Times

Bottom line: Russia's full seizure of Japan Tobacco's Russian entities represents a step-change escalation in economic pressure on Japanese corporate assets; simultaneously, the APEC Xi-snub risk crystallizes the central diplomatic test for PM Takaichi heading into Beijing — with no confirmed bilateral on the schedule.

U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

BASING · MOD JAPAN

Japan-US Joint Committee reaches new agreement on USFJ arrangements

Japan's Ministry of Defense announced that the Japan-US Joint Committee — the bilateral body that administers US Forces Japan basing agreements — reached a new agreement on November 9; the substance of the agreement was not detailed in available articles.

BASING · MAINICHI

New Okinawa Governor Koja backs Henoko relocation as fastest way to remove base risks

Newly elected Okinawa Governor **Genta Koja** stated Monday that he supports relocating the US military air base to Henoko within Okinawa as the fastest means of reducing risks to residents — a reversal of his predecessor's opposition that removes the most significant local political obstacle to the Futenma replacement plan.

INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

SOUTHEAST ASIA · THE JAPAN TIMES

Japan and Vietnam agree to strengthen economic security and energy ties at Tokyo summit
PM Sanae Takaichi and Vietnamese President To Lam are expected to affirm deeper economic security and energy cooperation at their Tokyo summit Monday, amid rising regional geopolitical and trade tensions.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA
Japan and Vietnam sign energy deals as Hanoi's power demand surges
Japan and Vietnam signed energy cooperation deals at the Tokyo summit, targeting Vietnam's rapidly growing power needs through frameworks that extend Japanese energy-security engagement in Southeast Asia.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA
ANA and Vietnam Airlines to launch revenue-sharing partnership
ANA and **Vietnam Airlines** are set to launch a revenue-sharing arrangement, deepening bilateral aviation ties alongside the broader Japan-Vietnam summit agenda.

EXPERT ANALYSIS AND EVENTS

OP-EDS & THINK TANK COMMENTARY

SASAKAWA PEACE FOUNDATION
"China's Nuclear Buildup and Japan-U.S. Deterrence Response"

> *China's accelerating nuclear buildup requires Japan and the United States to develop a coordinated deterrence response that goes beyond existing alliance frameworks.*

The Sasakawa Peace Foundation analysis examines how China's nuclear expansion affects extended deterrence commitments under the US-Japan alliance. It addresses the challenge of sustaining credible deterrence as the PRC approaches rough numerical parity with US and Russian arsenals in some categories. The piece comes as Japan's 2026 Three Strategic Documents review is underway and Beijing has criticized Tokyo's defense posture.

SO WHAT With Japan's Three Strategic Documents review active, this analysis frames the nuclear dimension that the review must address — specifically how US extended deterrence credibility is affected by China's buildup.

UPCOMING

Nov 9
Japan-Vietnam Summit — Tokyo (today, forthcoming)
PM Takaichi and Vietnamese President To Lam are due to hold summit talks in Tokyo today, expected to cover energy security, economic security, AI and quantum technology cooperation, and an ANA–Vietnam Airlines commercial partnership.

Nov 15
Fukuoka mayoral election and Tokyo ward elections (Shinjuku, Shinagawa) vote count
Asahi is scheduling live results coverage for November 15 for the Fukuoka mayoral race and two Tokyo ward executive elections — local contests that will serve as a bellwether for the Takaichi cabinet's current polling weakness.

Nov 15
APEC Summit in Beijing — Takaichi-Xi encounter uncertain
Japan's diplomatic effort to secure even a brief Takaichi-Xi encounter at APEC is ongoing; multiple outlets report uncertainty persists over whether China will grant a bilateral meeting one year after Takaichi's Taiwan remarks.

Nov
COP31 climate summit under way in Turkey

17	COP31 opened in Turkey with calls to address emissions, energy security, and AI data-center impacts; PM Takaichi has announced she will not attend, per Kyodo News.
Mar 31	**Current Host-Nation Support Special Measures Agreement expires** The Japan-US host-nation support agreement runs through March 31, 2027 at approximately ¥211 billion/year; successor negotiations will accelerate in the coming months.

CSIS Japan Chair

JAPAN DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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